

Confidential data should be put in the `.env` file. Most confidential data are already included in the settings for production explained on the previous page, except `SECRET_KEY`. `SECRET_KEY` is not specific for production, but it should be confidentially managed and saved under the `.env` file.

Note: SECRET_KEY

According to the Django official documentation, `SECRET_KEY` is used to provide cryptographic signing and should be set to a unique, unpredictable value. Running Django with a known `SECRET_KEY` defeats many of Django's security protections and can lead to privilege escalation and remote code execution vulnerabilities.

When you initiated the Django project, the secret key was already generated, and you can use it for production; however, you should not expose it to the public. In practice, you need to make sure that you won't push the information to the GitHub repository.

Key steps to use django-environ

Here are the key steps to use `django-environ` for our Django app.

1. Install django-environ

Add `django-environ` in `requirements.txt` and install the package.

`requirements.txt`

```
Django==4.1.7
django-crispy-forms
crispy-bootstrap5
django-allauth
django-environ
```

As we haven't created the virtual environment, actual installation will be done later in this chapter.

2. Edit production.py